

Remote Participation Policy

1. Purpose

This policy governs the conditions under which a student may participate in a face-to-face course session remotely (via video conferencing) and still be counted as present.

2. Eligibility for Remote Participation

Remote participation is a privilege, not a right. It is available only when: (a) the student has a documented reason that prevents in-person attendance (illness, medical isolation order, travel for university business); (b) the instructor has pre-approved the remote arrangement in writing; and (c) the course structure is compatible with remote attendance (lectures, seminars — not lab or studio courses).

3. Advance Notice Requirement

Remote participation requests must be made at least 24 hours before the class session, except in cases of sudden illness, for which a same-day request with documentation may be accepted at the instructor's discretion. Requests submitted after the class has begun will not be granted.

4. Technical Requirements

- Stable internet connection capable of video streaming
- Functioning camera that must remain on throughout the session
- Working microphone with the ability to participate in discussion
- Quiet environment free from significant background noise
- Use of Westbrook University's approved video conferencing platform (Zoom or Teams)

5. Attendance Credit

A student who participates remotely with prior approval and remains actively engaged throughout the session (camera on, responsive to questions) will be marked as present. Students who connect but do not participate actively, or whose connection is lost for more than 25% of the session, will be marked as absent.

6. Limitations

No student may attend more than 5 sessions of any single face-to-face course remotely in a given semester without obtaining a formal accommodation from the Office of Disability Services (ODS). Exceeding this limit without an ODS accommodation results in the absences being recorded as

unexcused.